

# InkMaster Studio

A browser-based print-prep workflow for apparel graphics. InkMaster helps creators turn rough source art into DTG-ready assets with knockout cleanup, texture controls, underbase generation, mockup previews, and export tooling built around actual garment production needs.

**From rough artwork to print-ready merch assets in one focused workflow.**



## Project Position

Shadewater Labs merch-production workflow

Public beta with a real browser-based operator surface

Built for DTG prep, previews, and production export

## Overall Progress

**76%**

The beta is real, useful, and now focused on polish and product clarity.

## Print Core

**88%**

The standardized print-master flow, DPI feedback, and garment prep are already strong.

## Mockups & Export

**84%**

Underbases, mockups, PDF export, and production assets make it feel like a real operator tool.

## Workflow Memory

**71%**

Batching, presets, checkpoints, and export history are working but still being refined.

## Why It Exists

Most apparel graphics are not born print-ready. They need cleanup, resizing, texture preservation, mockups, and export prep before they can actually be sold or printed. InkMaster exists to compress those repetitive last-mile steps into one focused browser workflow.

### Print-first cleanup

Remove black or white backgrounds, preserve distress and transparency, and shape edges for garments instead of forcing generic image tools to do specialized print work.

### Production assets

Generate print masters, underbases, PDFs, SVGs, and mockup-ready outputs from the same session instead of bouncing between multiple tools.

### Merch preview loop

Preview designs on multiple garment colors, compare placements, and produce sellable mockups without leaving the app.

### Beta with real utility

The live product already solves a real operator problem: taking messy source art and turning it into something printable and merch-ready faster.

## Core Workflow

InkMaster is strongest when the workflow stays tight: validate the artwork, prep it for the garment, preview it on real surfaces, and export both production files and merch assets from the same session.

01

### Upload and validate

Start with raw artwork, normalize it into a 4200 x 5100 print master, and surface DPI feedback so weak source files get flagged early.

02

### Prep the artwork

Choose the right garment-prep mode, remove black or white backgrounds, refine thresholds, preserve texture, replace colors, and shape the final print feel.

03

### Preview on real surfaces

Check the processed design on artboards and garment mockups, compare colors, test placement, and confirm the asset still reads once it leaves a neutral editor background.

04

### Export production assets

Download the final print file, create PDFs and underbases, or batch out mockup sets so the same workflow supports both production and merchandising.

## Who It Is For

InkMaster is best for people who already know they need to print something and want a faster route from rough art to a sellable or production-ready result.

### Merch creators

Independent creators who want to move faster from rough artwork to something they can actually list, print, and sell.

### Apparel brands & print shops

Small operators who need repeatable DTG prep, mockup output, and better consistency without a bloated studio workflow.

### Freelance designers

Designers who inherit messy files and need a faster route to production-ready graphics for client merch work.

### Shadewater Labs ops

A live internal test bed for understanding where a focused merch-production product is already strong and where it still needs polish.

## Why It Is Different

### Not a general creative suite

The point is not to replace Photoshop. The point is to remove the repetitive merch-prep steps that most people end up doing inside Photoshop.

### More than background removal

Background cleanup matters, but the real value is the whole loop: sizing, DPI checks, texture control, underbase generation, mockups, and export packaging.

### More than a mockup toy

Mockups are part of the experience, but the real product sits earlier in the pipeline where artwork becomes print-ready in the first place.

### Browser-first workflow

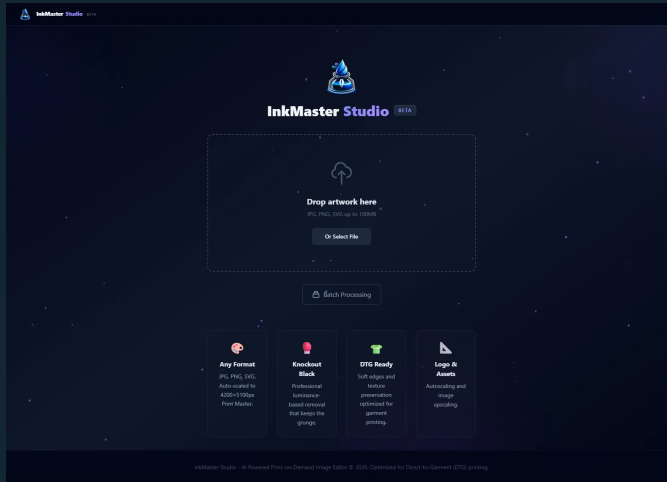
The key promise is speed and accessibility: do serious merch prep in a focused web workflow instead of getting buried in heavyweight desktop tools for every iteration.

## Real Output Surface

The project already has real product surface and artifact outputs. These pages and previews matter because they show the tool is operating on more than theory.

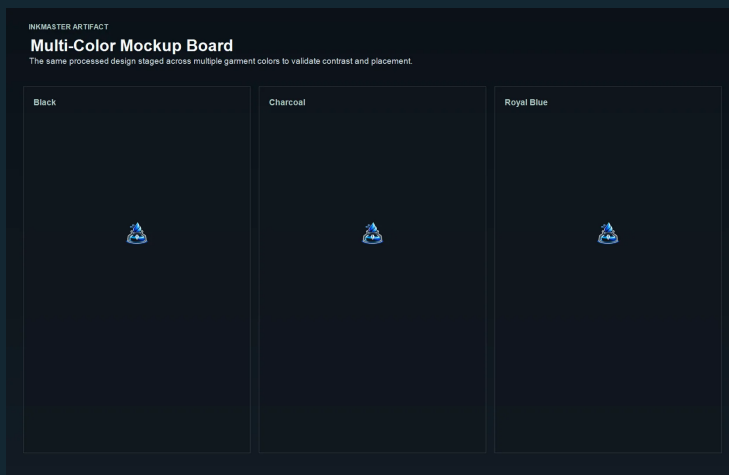
## Public beta landing page

The live site frames InkMaster around batch processing, print-master sizing, knockout cleanup, and DTG-focused output instead of generic image editing.



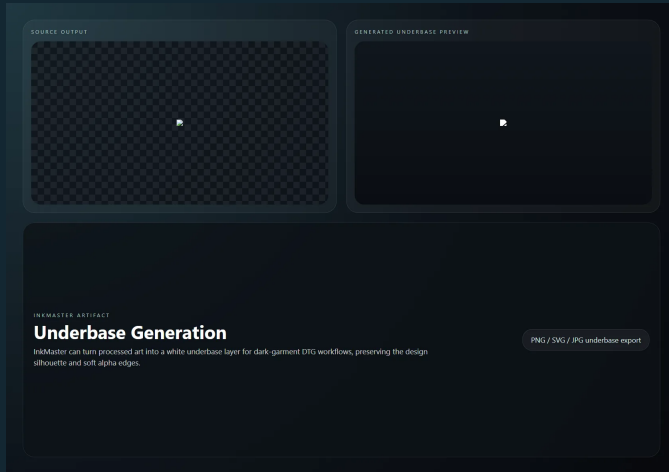
## Multi-color mockup board

The same processed design staged across multiple shirt colors shows whether the asset survives contrast, placement, and merchandising realities before shipping.



## Underbase generation preview

InkMaster can turn processed art into a white underbase layer for dark-garment DTG printing while preserving silhouette and soft alpha information.



## Current Limits

- The AI-assisted editing path exists in the codebase, but the public beta still treats it as an inactive future-facing feature rather than a fully shipped operator path.
- The workflow is still tee-first today even though the product story points toward hoodies, hats, mugs, totes, and broader merch surfaces.
- The underlying tools are stronger than the onboarding and public explanation around them, which is why the explainer and Labs page matter right now.

## What Comes Next

- Decide how to ship the AI editing layer in a production-safe way instead of leaving it as a beta curiosity.
- Expand beyond tees without diluting the clarity of the current print-prep workflow.
- Tighten onboarding, feature framing, and public messaging so the product clicks in a few seconds for new visitors.